

Investor profile

NAME: Mireia

AGE: 22

JOB: Adviser at Te Puni Kōkiri (Ministry of Maori Development)

1. What does your investment portfolio look like?

It's 60 per cent ETFs (exchange-traded funds; S&P 500, NZ top 50, Smartshares Europe Fund, etc.), 30 per cent managed funds (Simplicity growth fund and Pathfinder managed funds), 10 per cent individual companies (Air New Zealand, Tesla, Apple).

2. When did you begin investing and what was your first investment?

My first investment was about \$20 in Air New Zealand. I had no clue what I was doing and was only beginning to grasp the concept of investing. I remember thinking, 'When the borders open up then surely my money will increase in value?'

3. What stopped you from investing; were there any barriers you had to overcome?

Fear, anxiety and overwhelm around what to invest in. I tried to start investing back in 2020 after a friend had talked to me about the concept of it. I loved the idea of my money working for me, however, when I created an account on an investing platform, I felt completely lost and anxious around what to invest my money in! I remember comparing myself to all these people online who invested in companies before they grew immensely, and were now rolling in money! I remember realising that when I was looking through these companies, ETFs and index funds, it just made me feel afraid, because I didn't know how it all worked. I then decided to hold off until I knew what I was doing. The barrier I had to overcome was to educate myself and look at resources that simplified the concept of investing. I also had to not compare to other people's experiences, particularly on social media. At the